1ST ACCESS HOME CARE INC.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Virginia Home Care Organization
Private Duty Nursing & Respite Services

Revised September 2026

This handbook is intended for employees and, where applicable, contract personnel of 1st Access Home Care Inc. It is designed to reflect the agency's current scope of home care services and Virginia requirements applicable to a licensed home care organization.

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1. Welcome and Handbook Disclaimer

1st Access Home Care Inc. welcomes you to our team. Our employees are essential to the safe, respectful and reliable delivery of home care services to clients in their residences. This handbook provides general personnel expectations and agency procedures for employees working in personal care, private duty nursing and respite services.

The handbook is intended to be read together with the employee's job description, applicable clinical policies, client-specific plan of care or service, agency policies and procedures, and applicable federal and Virginia laws and regulations.

This handbook does not create a contract of employment or guarantee employment for any particular period. The agency may revise policies when operational needs, payer requirements, professional standards, or changes in law or regulation require revisions. Nothing in this handbook is intended to reduce or eliminate any right or protection provided by applicable law.

If a provision of this handbook conflicts with applicable federal or Virginia law or regulation, the applicable law or regulation will control. Employees should direct questions to the Administrator or designee.

Employment with the agency is at will to the extent permitted by law. Nothing in this handbook creates an express or implied promise of employment for a specific term.

2. Mission, Vision, Goals and Objectives

Mission

1st Access Home Care Inc. is committed to providing safe, dependable and respectful home care services that support clients in remaining in their homes and communities. The agency seeks to protect client dignity, promote independence, support family caregivers, and provide services within the scope of the agency's licensure, employee qualifications, client authorization and plan of care.

Vision

1st Access Home Care Inc. seeks to be a trusted Virginia home care provider recognized for reliable staffing, competent caregivers, respectful client relationships, effective communication and compliance with applicable regulatory requirements.

Goals and Objectives

- Provide services that are safe, appropriate and consistent with the client's authorized plan of care.
- Employ and retain qualified, competent and properly credentialed personnel.
- Protect client rights, privacy, dignity and property.
- Maintain adequate staffing and communication systems to reduce missed or delayed services.
- Identify, report and respond promptly to changes in client condition, incidents, complaints, abuse, neglect and safety concerns.
- Maintain effective infection prevention and control practices.
- Provide orientation, competency assessment and required continuing education.
- Maintain accurate personnel, service and administrative records.
- Continuously review agency operations for quality improvement and regulatory compliance.

3. Scope of Services and Service Area

1st Access Home Care Inc. operates as a Virginia home care organization and provides services within the scope authorized by its license, payer contracts, client authorizations and applicable law.

Current agency service focus:

- Private Duty Nursing – nursing services provided by appropriately qualified registered nurses (RNs) and licensed practical nurses (LPNs), as applicable, under an authorized plan of care.
- Personal Care Services – assistance with activities of daily living and instrumental activities of daily living, as authorized by the client's service plan and provided by appropriately qualified personnel.
- Respite Services – temporary relief for an unpaid family caregiver or other primary caregiver, provided within the specific service authorization and the employee's qualifications.

The agency does not represent that it provides every service listed in Virginia's home care regulations. Current services include private duty nursing, respite services and personal care services, as authorized and within the agency's license, payer requirements, client service plan and employee qualifications. Employees may not independently add, remove or change services, treatments, tasks, frequencies or hours that are not authorized.

Skilled nursing services must be provided in accordance with the applicable medical plan of care. Virginia regulations require nursing services to be provided by appropriately qualified RNs or LPNs, except for nursing tasks that may lawfully be delegated by an RN. Supervision is based on client needs, RN assessment and agency policy and may not exceed the applicable regulatory interval.

Service Area

The agency will maintain and update its service area in accordance with its Virginia license, staffing availability and operational capacity. Employees will be notified when service-area information changes.

4. Hours of Operation and On-Call Coverage

The agency's administrative office hours and after-hours/on-call coverage will be established by management and communicated to employees. Client services may occur outside normal administrative office hours, including evenings, nights, weekends and holidays, when authorized and scheduled.

Employees providing direct care must follow the assigned schedule and the agency's call-off and on-call procedures. An employee must not abandon an assigned client or leave a client without an authorized transition or replacement when coverage is required.

The agency will maintain staffing arrangements appropriate to the services offered and the assessed needs of clients, consistent with Virginia home care requirements.

5. Open Door and Communication Policy

Employees are encouraged to communicate promptly with their supervisor, Director of Nursing, Administrator or designee regarding questions, concerns, safety issues, client changes, scheduling problems or workplace concerns.

- Clinical concerns must be communicated through the clinical chain of command.
- Urgent client safety concerns must be reported immediately.
- Employees may raise compliance concerns without retaliation.
- Communication concerning clients must protect confidentiality and be limited to individuals with a legitimate need to know.

6. Equal Employment Opportunity and Anti-Harassment

1st Access Home Care Inc. provides equal employment opportunity and will comply with applicable federal and Virginia employment laws. Employment decisions will be made without unlawful discrimination.

Harassment, sexual harassment, retaliation, intimidation and discriminatory conduct are prohibited. Employees should report concerns to a supervisor, Administrator or other designated management representative as soon as possible.

The agency will review complaints appropriately and will take corrective action when warranted.

7. Employment Eligibility, Screening and Personnel Qualifications

Before beginning employment or direct client contact, employees must complete required hiring documentation and demonstrate the qualifications required for their position.

- Employment eligibility documentation must be completed as required by federal law.
- Employees must provide required licenses, certifications, registrations and other credentials.
- The agency will verify professional credentials as required.
- The agency will obtain the required sworn criminal-history disclosure and criminal record check for compensated employees.
- An employee may not perform duties outside the employee's education, training, license, certification, competency or authorized assignment.

Virginia's current home care regulations require personnel practices to comply with applicable law, a staffing plan appropriate to the services offered, verification of professional credentials, and the required criminal record screening.

Virginia law also restricts compensated employment of persons convicted of specified barrier crimes and requires a sworn disclosure and criminal history record process. A person generally may not have direct patient contact until the required original clearance or record has been received, subject to the statutory exception for direct supervision.

8. Confidentiality, HIPAA and Client Privacy

All employees must protect client information, agency business information and personnel information. Client information may be accessed, discussed or disclosed only for legitimate work purposes and as permitted or required by law.

- Do not discuss clients in public places or with individuals who are not involved in the client's care.
- Do not photograph, record or post client information or images without authorized agency and client/legal authorization.
- Do not use social media to identify or discuss clients, their homes, conditions, schedules or services.
- Secure paper and electronic records from unauthorized access.
- Use the minimum necessary information for legitimate business and care purposes when applicable.

Client records must receive confidential treatment as required by law and Virginia home care regulations. Client rights include privacy, confidentiality, freedom from abuse and neglect, participation in care planning, and the right to refuse services.

9. Scheduling, Attendance and Staffing Coverage

Reliable attendance is a core job responsibility in home care. Clients may depend on a scheduled employee for essential care.

- Employees must report to assigned visits on time and remain for the scheduled service period unless released by authorized management or an emergency requires departure.
- Employees must not change a client schedule without authorization.
- Employees must immediately notify the supervisor or on-call person if they cannot report for a scheduled shift.
- Employees may not arrange unauthorized substitutes.
- Employees must report any circumstance that could result in a missed, delayed or incomplete service.

The agency will use staffing procedures appropriate to the type and volume of services provided and the assessed needs of clients.

10. Timekeeping and Pay

Employees must accurately record all time worked. Time records must reflect actual start and end times and must not be falsified, altered improperly, or completed for another employee.

- Employees must follow the agency's approved timekeeping method.
- No employee may work off the clock.
- Employees must report payroll or timekeeping errors promptly.

11. Personnel Records and Credential Maintenance

The agency maintains confidential personnel records and will limit access to individuals with a legitimate business or regulatory need.

Employees are responsible for keeping the agency informed of changes affecting employment or credentialing, including contact information, emergency contacts, licenses, certifications and required training.

- Professional licenses and certifications must remain current.
- Employees must immediately notify the agency of any restriction, suspension, expiration or disciplinary action affecting a required credential.
- Required health, training and competency documentation must be submitted as directed.

12. Employee Categories, Benefits and Leave

Employees may be classified according to their job duties and employment status. Classification does not change the requirement to comply with applicable wage, leave, benefit, tax and employment laws.

Employees must request planned leave in advance whenever possible. Because client services must continue safely, leave requests are subject to staffing and operational requirements, except where applicable law provides otherwise.

The agency will administer legally protected leave and accommodations in accordance with applicable law.

13. Professional Conduct and Ethical Standards

Employees represent 1st Access Home Care Inc. while providing services. Conduct must support client safety, dignity and trust.

- Treat clients, families, coworkers and community partners respectfully.
- Follow the client's authorized plan of care/service and agency instructions.
- Maintain professional boundaries.
- Do not accept money, loans, personal financial favors or inappropriate gifts from clients or families.
- Do not privately contract with or solicit agency clients for services outside the agency.
- Do not falsify records or documentation.
- Do not sleep while responsible for a client.
- Do not report to work impaired by alcohol, illegal drugs or any substance that makes the employee unsafe to perform duties.
- Do not engage in abuse, neglect, exploitation, threats or violence.
- Do not bring unauthorized persons to a client's home.

14. Client-Home Conduct and Boundaries

The client's home is the workplace. Employees must respect the client's home, privacy, routines and property while maintaining appropriate professional boundaries.

- Enter the home only as authorized and identify yourself appropriately.
- Perform only assigned services within the employee's role and competency.
- Do not use client property, vehicles, financial accounts or personal belongings without authorization.
- Do not borrow money or personal property from a client.
- Do not use client social media accounts or post client information.
- Do not bring children, friends or other unauthorized persons to a client's home.
- Report unsafe environmental conditions to the supervisor.
- Report suspected abuse, neglect or exploitation immediately as required by law and agency policy.

15. Dress, Identification and Personal Hygiene

Employees providing direct care must maintain clean, safe and professional attire(scrubs) appropriate to the assigned duties and infection-control requirements.

- Wear agency identification when required.
- Wear appropriate footwear for safe client care.
- Maintain personal hygiene appropriate for direct care.
- Keep hair and nails maintained in a manner consistent with safe clinical practice.
- Wear required personal protective equipment (PPE).

The agency may establish additional dress requirements for particular clients, procedures or infection-control situations.

16. Safety, Infection Prevention and Control

Infection prevention is a core responsibility for all employees. Employees must follow the agency's infection prevention and control program, standard precautions, transmission-based precautions when indicated, hand hygiene requirements, PPE requirements and exposure-control procedures.

- Perform hand hygiene before and after client contact and at other required times.
- Use PPE based on anticipated exposure and agency procedures.
- Handle sharps safely and place them in approved sharps containers.
- Report exposures, needlestick injuries, blood/body-fluid exposures and communicable illness promptly.
- Clean and disinfect equipment according to agency procedures and manufacturer instructions.
- Do not work while experiencing an illness or condition that makes direct client care unsafe; notify the supervisor for instructions.

Virginia's home care regulations require written policies addressing communicable and reportable diseases and other operational matters. The agency's infection-control procedures are intended to complement those requirements.

17. Communicable Illness and Influenza

Employees must report known or suspected communicable illness that could affect safe client care to the supervisor or designated clinical manager before reporting to a client visit, when feasible.

Influenza and other respiratory infections are addressed through the agency's infection-control approach. Employees should not knowingly expose vulnerable clients to a communicable illness. Management may modify assignments, require appropriate precautions, or direct an employee to remain away from client care when clinically or operationally appropriate.

Employees must follow current agency instructions regarding respiratory symptoms, exposure, testing, vaccination documentation when applicable to a particular assignment or payer requirement, PPE and return to work.

The prior handbook specifically referenced influenza in its infection-control provisions; this revised handbook retains influenza within a broader communicable-illness framework rather than treating influenza as a standalone employment requirement.

18. Drug-Free Workplace and Smoking

The agency prohibits employees from working while impaired by alcohol or illegal drugs and prohibits unlawful possession, use, distribution or sale of controlled substances in connection with employment.

The agency will maintain a drug-free workplace policy consistent with Virginia law and applicable employment requirements. Virginia law requires home care organizations to establish policies for maintaining a drug-free workplace and permits drug testing in circumstances authorized by law.

Smoking and vaping are prohibited in client homes and in any area where prohibited by law, client requirements or agency policy. Employees must not use tobacco or vaping products while providing direct care.

19. Orientation, Competency and In-Service Education

All new employees must complete agency orientation before independently providing services. Orientation will be appropriate to the employee's position and may include:

- Agency mission, policies and procedures.
- Client rights and responsibilities.
- Confidentiality and HIPAA requirements.
- Infection prevention and control.
- Emergency procedures.

- Abuse, neglect and exploitation reporting.
- Incident reporting.
- Job-specific competencies.
- Client-specific training when required.
- Safety, boundaries and professional conduct.

Employees must maintain competency for assigned duties. Competency may be assessed at hire, when duties change, periodically, after an incident, or when otherwise required.

For personal care services, Virginia regulations require at least 12 hours of annual in-service education for home attendants. If the agency provides personal care services, applicable training requirements will be incorporated into the agency's training program.

20. Complaints, Grievances and Client Concerns

The agency will maintain a process for receiving, documenting, investigating and responding to employee and client complaints.

- Employees may report concerns to a supervisor, Administrator or designee.
- Client complaints must be forwarded promptly through the agency's complaint process.
- Complaints concerning abuse, neglect, exploitation, serious safety issues or professional misconduct must be escalated immediately.
- Retaliation for making a good-faith complaint is prohibited.

Virginia requires written client-rights policies and requires those rights to be reviewed with clients or their designees upon admission and documented in the client's record.

21. Abuse, Neglect and Exploitation Reporting

Employees must report suspected abuse, neglect or exploitation in accordance with Virginia law and agency policy. Employees must not investigate suspected abuse independently or confront an alleged perpetrator when doing so could compromise safety.

- Protect the client from immediate danger when possible and appropriate.
- Notify the supervisor/Administrator immediately.
- Complete required agency incident documentation.
- Make required reports to Adult Protective Services, Child Protective Services, law enforcement or other authorities as required by law.
- Maintain client confidentiality while making and documenting required reports.

The agency's prior handbook already required reporting of suspected child and adult abuse and neglect and included Virginia reporting information. The revised policy retains the reporting obligation while directing employees to use current agency contact information and current statutory reporting procedures rather than relying on outdated phone numbers.

22. Employee Injury and Incident Reporting

Employees must immediately report work-related injuries, exposures, accidents, client incidents, unsafe conditions and other reportable events to the supervisor or designated management representative.

- Seek emergency medical attention when necessary.
- Complete the required incident or injury report promptly.

- Cooperate with follow-up, investigation and workers' compensation procedures.
- Do not alter or conceal information about an incident.

The original handbook required immediate reporting of work injuries and written incident documentation. This revised policy keeps that requirement while using a general timeframe so the agency's current incident-reporting policy can establish the specific deadline for each type of event.

23. Emergency Preparedness and Inclement Weather

The agency will maintain emergency preparedness procedures appropriate to home care operations. Employees must follow instructions for severe weather, power outages, disasters, infectious disease events, evacuation, client emergencies and other disruptions.

- Do not place yourself or a client in unreasonable danger.
- Notify the agency promptly when weather or an emergency prevents safe travel.
- Follow client-specific emergency plans when applicable.
- Maintain communication with the agency during an emergency.

The agency will balance continuity of essential client services with employee and client safety.

24. Information Technology and Electronic Communications

Agency electronic systems are for authorized business purposes. Employees must protect passwords, devices, records and client information.

- Do not share passwords.
- Do not access client information without a legitimate work-related need.
- Do not transmit protected client information through unauthorized personal accounts or applications.
- Do not post confidential agency or client information on social media.
- Report suspected loss, theft, unauthorized access or disclosure promptly.

The agency may monitor and manage agency-owned systems consistent with law and agency policy.

25. Independent Contractors and Contracted Services

The agency will use employees and contractors only in accordance with applicable law and its licensure requirements. Contractors providing services on behalf of the agency must meet applicable qualification, screening, credentialing, contractual and policy requirements.

Virginia requires a written agreement for services provided by persons who are not employees of the organization. The agreement must address the services, participation in care planning, coordination and evaluation, documentation, scheduling, payment and required insurance, among other matters.

26. Performance Management and Corrective Action

Employees will be evaluated based on job responsibilities, competency, professional conduct, reliability, documentation, client service and compliance with agency policies.

Corrective action may include coaching, counseling, written warning, suspension, retraining, reassignment, removal from a case, or termination, depending on the circumstances and applicable law.

Serious violations may result in immediate removal from client care and/or termination. Examples include abuse or neglect, falsification of records, theft, serious confidentiality violations, working while impaired, violence, serious safety violations, practicing outside scope, or knowingly violating a client plan of care.

27. Termination and Separation

Employees who resign should provide notice consistent with agency expectations unless circumstances or applicable law provide otherwise. The agency may end employment consistent with applicable law and the employee's employment status.

- Agency property must be returned upon separation.
- Keys, badges, devices and client materials must be returned as directed.
- Outstanding documentation must be completed.
- Confidentiality obligations continue after employment ends.

Where required, the agency will make appropriate reports to licensing or regulatory authorities concerning professional misconduct, impairment, incompetence, negligence or other reportable conduct.

28. Reporting Professional Violations

The agency will comply with applicable Virginia reporting requirements concerning licensed or certified health professionals. Employees and managers must promptly report suspected professional incompetence, negligence, unethical or unprofessional conduct, impairment, abuse or other conduct requiring regulatory reporting to the appropriate agency representative.

Virginia law contains reporting requirements for certain practitioner violations and related conduct. The agency will use the current applicable statute and licensing-board requirements when making reports.

29. Policy Review and Regulatory Compliance

1st Access Home Care Inc. will maintain written policies and procedures appropriate to its services and will review them at least annually and when changes in law, regulation, services, operations or identified risks require revision.

Virginia's home care regulations require written policies and procedures approved by the governing body and annual review. Required areas include administrative records, admission/discharge criteria, informed consent, advance directives, client rights, contract services, medication management when applicable, quality improvement, mandated reporting, communicable/reportable diseases and other required operational topics. □cite□turn0search14□

The agency will maintain only those services, procedures and requirements applicable to its actual scope of operation. Policies will not state that the agency provides a service that it does not provide or that an employee must perform a task outside the employee's qualifications or authorized scope.

30. Employee Acknowledgment

I acknowledge that I have received the 1st Access Home Care Inc. Employee Handbook. I understand that I am responsible for reading and following the policies and procedures applicable to my position. I understand that the handbook is not a contract of employment and that policies may be revised as permitted by law.

I understand that I must protect client privacy and confidentiality, follow the client's authorized plan of care/service, maintain required credentials and competency, report safety concerns and suspected abuse or neglect, and comply with applicable federal and Virginia laws and regulations.

I understand that if I have questions about a policy or my responsibilities, I should contact my supervisor, Director of Nursing, Administrator or designee.

Regulatory Reference Note

This handbook was revised to fit 1st Access Home Care Inc.'s Virginia home care scope, including private duty nursing, respite services and personal care services, and to remove or avoid references to services not identified as part of the current business scope.

Primary Virginia regulatory references used for this revision include the Virginia Administrative Code provisions governing home care organizations, including 12VAC5-381, and applicable provisions of the Code of Virginia concerning licensure, personnel screening and professional reporting. The agency should confirm the exact services and payer requirements reflected on its current license and contracts before final adoption.

This document is an operational handbook draft and is not a substitute for legal advice or a formal regulatory survey. Management should approve the final handbook before implementation.